Odisha only during elections will not help you. Do you remember the promises you had made in 2014 and 2019? The people of Odisha remember your promise to reduce the prices of LPG, petrol and diesel, to create two crore jobs, to provide mobile connectivity to all, to reduce and waive GST. You have forgotten all these unfulfilled promises, but people of the state have not forgotten any of these." On May 29, at a rally in Baripada, the PM went to the extent of holding Pandian responsible for Naveen's deteriorating health. The CM promptly held a press conference and refuted the PM's allegations.

However, even as the BJP gets personal in its campaign, Naveen in his rallies prefers to focus on his track record of development, the numerous welfare schemes of his government and his vision and game plan to make Odisha the top-ranking state in the country should he win another term. The Bhubaneswar roadshow was typical of this style of campaigning. When his green election campaign bus bedecked with white conch shells arrived, it was greeted with a burst of crackers and a shower of confetti. The crowd cheered loudly when the hydraulic lift bearing Naveen glided to the top. Attired in his trademark white cotton kurta-pyjama, Naveen, his silver-grey hair slightly askew, waved vigorously to the crowd before picking up the microphone.

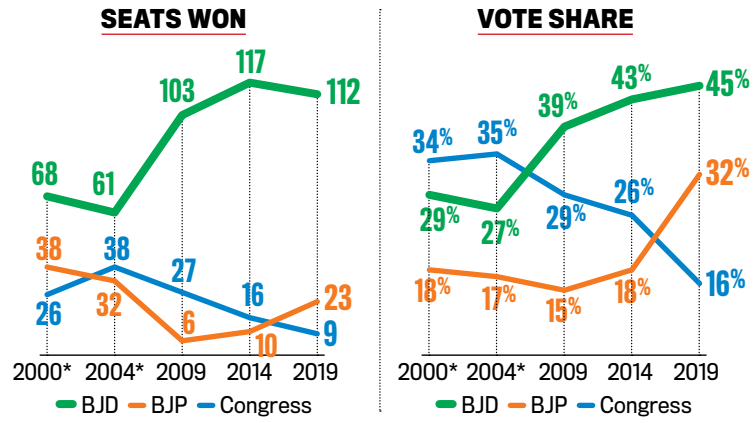
KEEPING IT SIMPLE

Shorn of oratorical flourish, he made a crisp and characteristically brief speech, sticking to his key poll promises. Speaking in Odia, he asked his audience: "You will get free electricity from July, are you happy?" The crowd roared its approval. He then asked the same of the Biju Swasthya Kalyan Yojana (BSKY), as part of which Odia citizens get free treatment in the best private hospitals, and the cheers were even louder. The response was the same when he talked about KALIA (Krushak

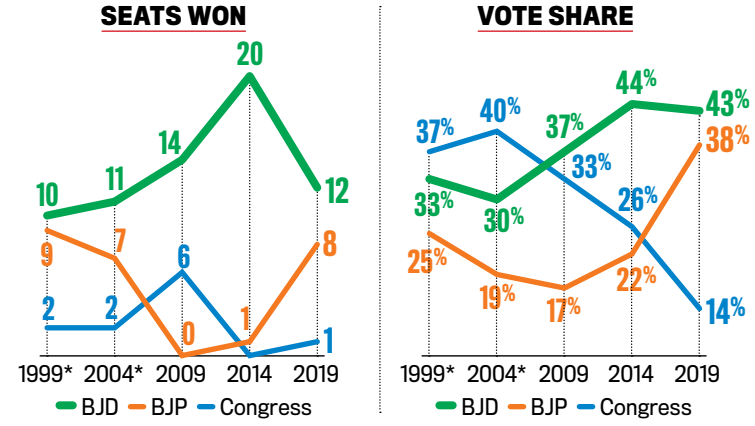
THE ELECTORAL JOURNEY OF NAVEEN PATNAIK

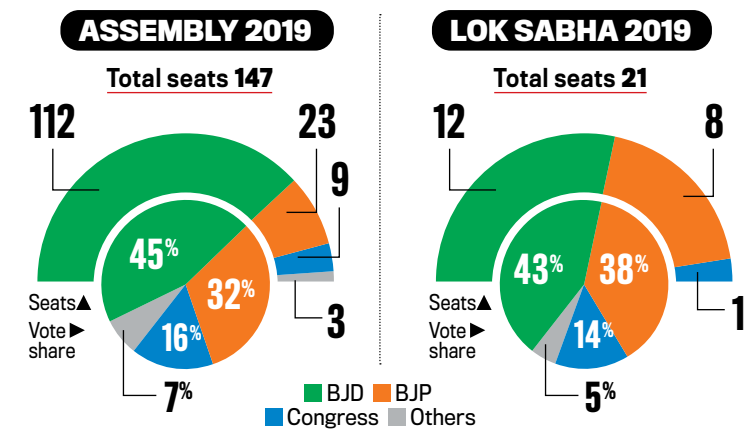
The Odisha chief minister's consistent election victories since 1999 speak of his enduring appeal and strategic brilliance in state politics

ASSEMBLY ELECTIONS



LOK SABHA ELECTIONS





**BJD and BJP fought elections together till 2004 as part of NDA; Figures have been rounded off*

Graphics by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY